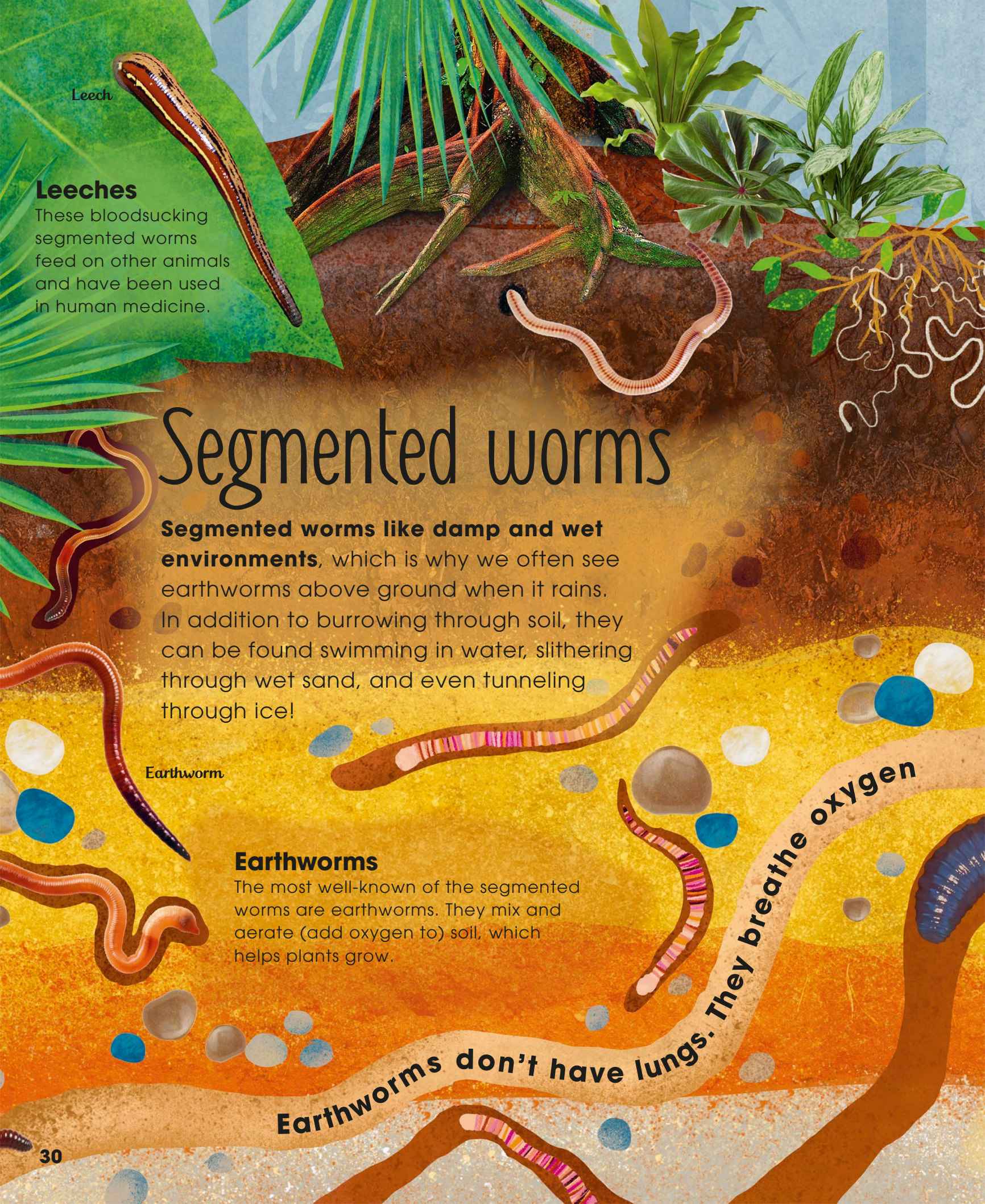


An artistic illustration of a leech on a green leaf. The leech is dark brown with a lighter, segmented body. It is positioned on a large, vibrant green leaf. In the background, there are other green plants and a brown, textured ground surface. The overall style is colorful and detailed.

Leech

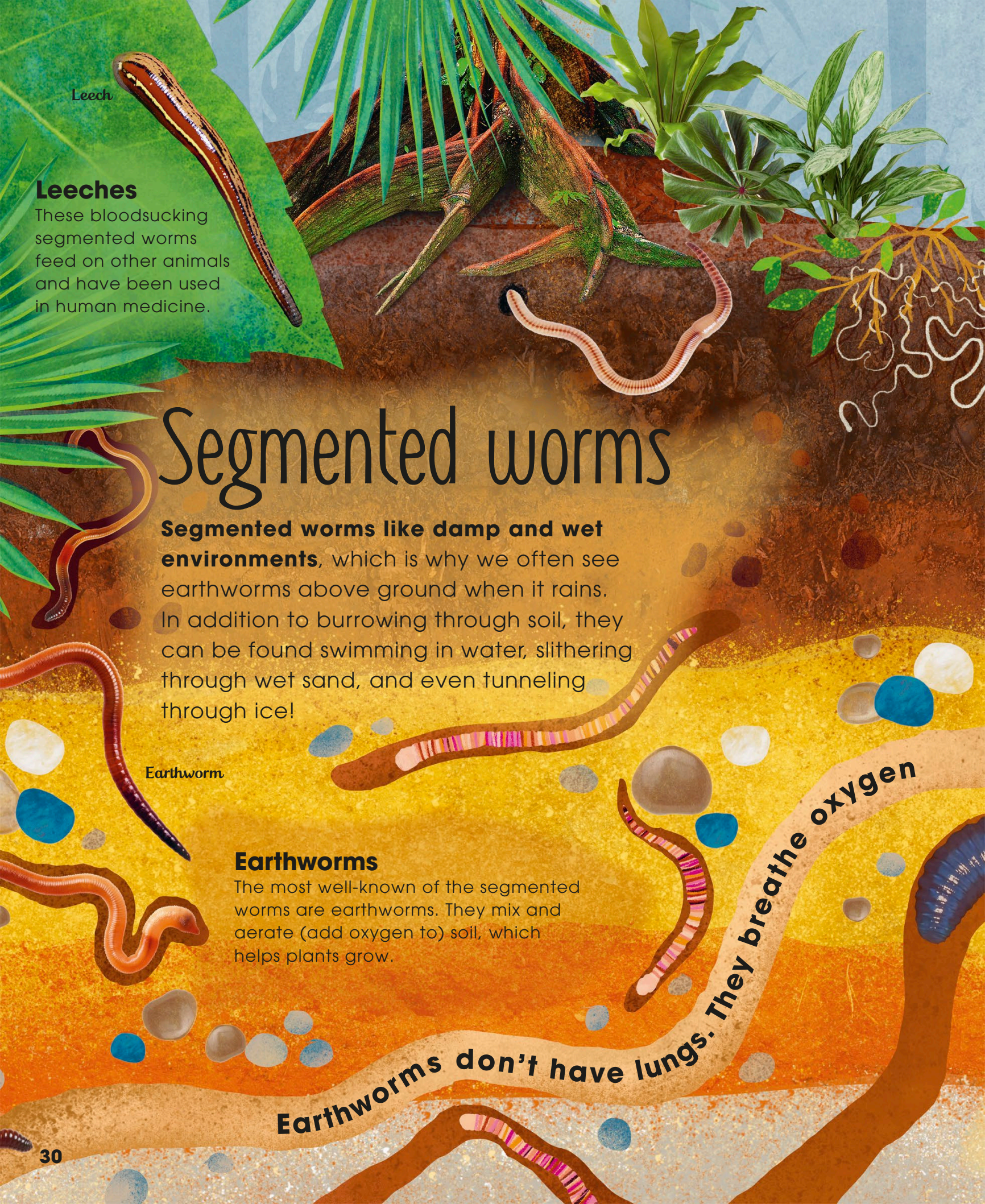
Leeches

These bloodsucking segmented worms feed on other animals and have been used in human medicine.

Segmented worms

Segmented worms like damp and wet environments, which is why we often see earthworms above ground when it rains.

In addition to burrowing through soil, they can be found swimming in water, slithering through wet sand, and even tunneling through ice!

An artistic illustration of an earthworm in soil. The worm is pinkish-brown with distinct segments. It is shown in a cross-section of the earth, with various colored soil layers (yellow, orange, brown) and small rocks. The worm is burrowing through the soil. The overall style is colorful and detailed.

Earthworm

Earthworms

The most well-known of the segmented worms are earthworms. They mix and aerate (add oxygen to) soil, which helps plants grow.

Earthworms don't have lungs. They breathe oxygen